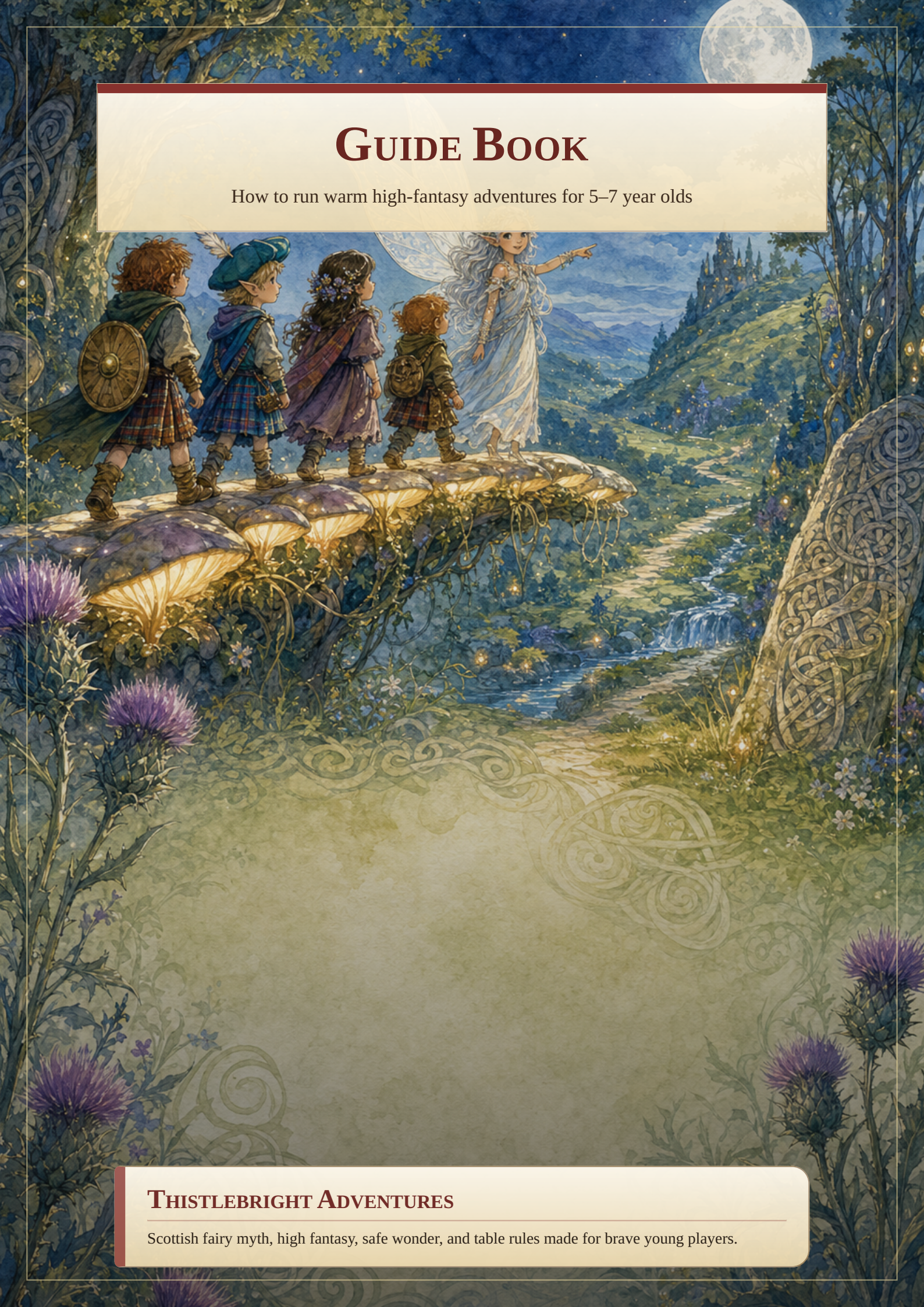




GUIDE BOOK

How to run warm high-fantasy adventures for 5–7 year olds

THISTLEBRIGHT ADVENTURES

Scottish fairy myth, high fantasy, safe wonder, and table rules made for brave young players.

YOUR JOB AS GUIDE

The Guide is not the boss of fun. You describe the world, listen to children, ask what they try, and help the dice turn ideas into surprises.



Guide stance: make every scene readable from the art, then support the child's idea.

- Use short scenes: 5 to 12 minutes each.
- Give choices in twos or threes, not long menus.
- Name feelings before fights: scared, proud, sleepy, lonely, worried.
- Let the children succeed often. The fun is in how it happens.

Safety tone: no gore, no cruelty, no permanent harm. Trouble can be spooky, muddy, noisy, or puzzling.

Useful phrases

- “Yes, and what does that look like?”
- “Who are you helping?”
- “Which stat fits your idea?”
- “That is a wobble, so something funny changes.”

SCENE RECIPE

1. A picture

Start with something children can see: misty bridge, silver fox, giant teacup, glowing thistle.

2. A feeling

Pick one: worried, excited, lonely, sleepy, proud, grumpy, curious.

3. A choice

Offer two helpful directions: follow the bells or talk to the fox.

4. A roll

Only roll if the answer is exciting. Use Brave, Kind, or Quick.

5. A change

After each scene, something should be different: a clue, friend, promise, opened path, or new question.

Read aloud: “The moon is caught in the loch like a silver coin. The kelpie foal stamps, worried and wet. What do you do?”



CREATURES ARE CHARACTERS

A creature should usually want something before it blocks something. Children can help, trick, soothe, race, sing, or befriend it.

RUNNING ROLLS AND WOBBLES

Choosing the stat

- Use **Brave** when the hero faces pressure.
- Use **Kind** when feelings, friendship, or care matter.
- Use **Quick** when speed, balance, noticing, or sneaking matters.

Good wobbles

- A hat blows away.
- The map gets wet.
- A bell rings and wakes someone.
- A helpful creature misunderstands.
- A path opens, but it is muddy.

Never make a wobble mean “you did nothing.”
Always move the story.

BUILDING ADVENTURES

Part	Question	Example
Hook	Who needs help?	A fairy cannot find the right door.
Path	Where must heroes go?	Across the heather bridge.
Friend	Who can help?	A shy fox with silver whiskers.
Puzzle	What needs a clever choice?	Three bells ring, but only one is kind.
Ending	How is the glen warmer now?	The lost moon-bell is returned.

Guide promise: prepare situations, not answers. If the child invents a kind solution, let it matter.

TINY TABLES

What is strange here?

1	A thistle glows like a lantern.
2	Footprints turn into tiny flowers.
3	A crow speaks only in compliments.
4	The bridge asks for a joke.
5	A teacup storm rains indoors.
6	A sleeping troll snores bubbles.

What does the creature want?

1	A snack.
2	A song.
3	Someone to listen.
4	A lost button.
5	Help being brave.
6	A promise kept.

How can it enter a scene?

1	It blocks a path by accident.
2	It is crying quietly.
3	It has the clue but misunderstands it.
4	It challenges the heroes to a silly contest.
5	It asks for a promise.
6	It follows the heroes home.